

Backyard Legends — Phase 1 Game Design Document

1. Game Overview

Backyard Legends is a competitive, street-style 4-player Spades game focused on skill, pressure, and real-game energy.

- 1 Platform: iOS + Android
- 2 Mode: Offline (Phase 1)
- 3 Players: 4 (2v2 teams)
- 4 Goal: First team to reach 100 / 200 / 500 points

2. Core Experience

- 1 Feels like playing with real people
- 2 Competitive, fast, and pressure-based
- 3 Clean but gritty visual direction
- 4 No casino-style UI

3. Player Positions

- 1 You (Bottom)
- 2 Partner (Top)
- 3 Opponent (Left)
- 4 Opponent (Right)

4. Game Modes

Classic Mode

- 1 Standard Spades rules
- 2 Must follow suit
- 3 Spades must be broken

Street Mode

- 1 Spades can be played anytime
- 2 Renege is allowed

Renege Rule: If a player fails to follow suit when able and is caught, penalty is -200 points.

5. Bidding System

- 1 Each player bids individually
- 2 Team bids are combined
- 3 Minimum team bid: 4 books
- 4 Bid range: 0–15 books
- 5 Nil only allowed if losing by 150+ points

6. Gameplay Rules

- 1 52-card deck
- 2 13 cards per player
- 3 Clockwise turn order
- 4 Must follow suit if possible
- 5 If not, can play any card
- 6 Highest spade wins
- 7 If no spade, highest of lead suit wins

7. Scoring System

- 1 +10 per successful book
- 2 -10 per failed book
- 3 Bags tracked; every 10 bags = -100 points
- 4 Nil success = +100
- 5 Nil failure = -100

8. Turn System

Turn-Based Mode

No timer.

Live Mode

- 1 30-second timer per turn
- 2 Auto-play after timeout
- 3 After 3 auto-plays: player is dropped
- 4 Dropped player replaced with AI

Partner can choose to continue with AI or forfeit.

9. AI System

- 1 Fills empty seats
- 2 Makes valid, rule-based moves
- 3 Not strategic (Phase 1)

10. Game Flow

- 1 Start game
- 2 Deal cards
- 3 Bidding phase
- 4 Trick play loop
- 5 Score update
- 6 Repeat rounds
- 7 Win condition reached

11. UI / UX Direction

- 1 Dark theme (charcoal/black)

- 2 Gold and red accents
- 3 High contrast
- 4 Street-style feel

12. Special Features

- 1 Last hand display
- 2 Set Book trigger (animation placeholder)

13. Non-Negotiables

- 1 All rules must follow this document
- 2 Full match playable end-to-end
- 3 No broken states
- 4 Clean architecture for future multiplayer

14. Not Included (Phase 1)

- 1 Multiplayer
- 2 Matchmaking
- 3 Accounts
- 4 Leaderboards
- 5 Voice/chat
- 6 Advanced AI